

2c. Content of Drama and poetry pre-1900 (Component 01)

Learners are required to study **one** play by Shakespeare which will be assessed in Section 1 of this component. In addition, learners are required to study **one** pre-1900 drama text and **one** pre-1900 poetry text which will both be assessed in Section 2.

For Section 1, the Shakespeare plays have been chosen carefully to ensure a varied selection for both teachers and learners. This section requires learners to demonstrate their detailed knowledge and understanding of their chosen play.

For Section 2, the texts have been chosen carefully so that they illuminate one another and so that learners are able to establish connections between their chosen texts from the genres of drama and poetry. Learners are expected to demonstrate their appreciation of the significance of cultural and contextual influences on the writers, readers and/or audiences and be able to explore relationships between their chosen texts. This section requires learners to read texts in a variety of ways and respond critically and creatively.

Drama and poetry pre-1900		
Section 1 set texts: Shakespeare	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners study one Shakespeare play. The set texts for examination until 2026 are: • Coriolanus • Hamlet • Measure for Measure • Richard III • The Tempest • Twelfth Night The set texts for first teaching from 2025 and examination from 2027 are: • Hamlet • King Lear • Othello • Richard III • The Taming of the Shrew • The Tempest	Learners are required to analyse the text in close detail, exploring Shakespeare's use of language and dramatic effects. Learners are required to consider issues raised in a specific extract in relation to their understanding of the play as a whole. Learners are required to explore ways in which the chosen play is/has been interpreted by different audiences, including over time.	• analyse ways in which Shakespeare shapes meanings in the chosen play including the function and effects of structure, form and language • articulate informed, personal and creative responses to the chosen Shakespeare play, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression • explore the play informed by different interpretations • consider different interpretations across time.

Where a passage is printed on the question paper it will be taken from the *The Complete Works of William Shakespeare: The Alexander Text* (Collins Classics). Centres are free to use any edition of their chosen Shakespeare text but should avoid using heavily edited editions.